Five remote-work routes, five different tests

Remote-work route

Rules checked October 20, 2026



Japan	Digital Nomad: 6 months, no extension.
Thailand DTV	5-year multiple-entry validity; 180 days per entry.

Five routes in this thread. Worker, money, nationality and application-location requirements differ.

Official rules: Japan MOFA · Royal Thai Embassy, London · Photo: Osaka (illustration)

Thailand DTV: eligibility

Remote-work route

Rules checked October 20, 2026



Funds	THB 500,000 financial evidence, plus remote-work/freelance evidence.
Duration	5-year multiple-entry visa; 180 days per entry. One extension up to 180 days, then depart and re-enter.
London only	Permanent residence in UK, Ireland or British Overseas Territories; police clearance issued within 6 months.

Apply within London's consular jurisdiction.

Official rules: Royal Thai Embassy, London · Photo: Bangkok (illustration)

Malaysia DE Rantau: tech versus non-tech

Remote-work route

Rules checked October 20, 2026



Tech income	USD 24,000/year minimum for freelancers or remote employees.
Non-tech income	USD 60,000/year minimum.
Pass + territory	3-12 months; up to 24 with renewal. Peninsular Malaysia and Labuan.

Employees need a foreign employer; freelancers may serve Malaysian clients. Contracts must have started at least 3 months before application.

Official rules: mdec.my · Photo: Kuala Lumpur (illustration)

Japan: income, insurance and nationality

Remote-work route

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Annual income	At least JPY 10 million for remote work.
Insurance	Death, injury or illness cover; at least JPY 10 million for injury/illness treatment.
Stay	6 months, no extension.

Principal-applicant nationality list: US included; India absent. The spouse/child list differs.

Costa Rica: evidence for the previous year

Remote-work route

Rules checked October 20, 2026



Monthly income	USD 3,000 individual / USD 4,000 with dependants, from overseas work. Evidence for the previous year.
Medical cover	At least USD 50,000 for the full stay; each dependant covered.
Estancia	1 year, renewable once.

Renewal requires at least 80 days physically in Costa Rica.

Barbados: income test and visa fee are separate

Remote-work route

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Expected income	At least USD 50,000 over the intended 12 months.
Fee after approval	USD 2,000 individual / USD 3,000 family; non-refundable.
Work + duration	12 months of remote work for overseas clients or employers.

Reapplication is possible after the year.